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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (Honours)/ MGU-BBA (Honours)/ MGU-BCA (Honours)

REGULAR EXAMINATION October 2026Fifth SEMESTER

DSE - MG5DSEPOL304 - EMERGING TRENDSIN INDIAN ADMINISTRATION

Part A One Word Answer all questions Each question carries 1 marks

1. January 1, 2015

2. Article 151 / (Articles 148 to 151)

3. State Election Commission

4. Build Own Operate (BOO)

5. Warren Hastings

6. Central Secretariat

7. Public Accounts Committee

8. Municipal Commissioner

9. Common Services Centre

10. Central Vigilance Commission (CVC) Act, 2003 **[1x10 = 10]**

Part BShort Answer QuestionsAnswer any 6 questionsEach question carries 5 marks

11. The Union Public Service Commission (UPSC) and State Public Service Commissions (SPSCs) are constitutional bodies responsible for recruiting personnel to public services in India. They differ in their jurisdiction, functions and scope of recruitment. UPSC-Established under Article 315 of the Constitution.Functions at the Union level.Recruits candidates for All India Services and Central Government services, as applicable.The President of India appoints the Chairman and members.The President has the authority to remove members under constitutional provisions.Submits its annual report to the President.State Public Service Commission (SPSC)-Established under Article 315 of the Constitution for each state.Functions at the state level. Recruits candidates for state government services.The Governor of the state appoints the Chairman and members.The Governor cannot independently remove members; removal is made by the President under constitutional provisions.Submits its annual report to the Governor.

12. The legislature plays an important role in controlling public expenditure and ensuring the proper use of public funds. Its major functions are: Approval of the Budget- Discussion and Voting on Demands for Grants- Control over Taxation- Financial Committees- Audit and Accountability- These functions promote transparency, accountability and economy in public administration.

13. Kerala Secretariat is a policy-making and staff agency that advises ministers and formulates laws, rules, and budgets, whereas Executive Directorates are line or implementation agencies that execute those policies on the ground and manage field-level operations.

14. The Build–Operate–Transfer (BOT) model is a public–private partnership (PPP) arrangement in which a private company builds an infrastructure project, operates it for a specified period, and then transfers it to the government.Limitations- High user charges- Risk of project delays- Profit-oriented approach- Complex contracts- Lack of transparency and accountability- Unequal distribution of benefits.

15.The e-District Mission Mode Project is an e-governance initiative aimed at delivering government services electronically at the district level.- Online service delivery- Transparency in procedures- Reduced administrative discretion- Application tracking- Accountability and reduced corruption.

16. In pre-colonial India, customs, religion and traditional institutions played an important role in shaping administration, governance and social relations.- Customs and traditions- Rulers often respected established traditions while administering justice- Influence of religion- Role of village institutions- Role of religious institutions - Social hierarchy and authority- However, these institutions sometimes reinforced caste inequalities and social exclusion.

17. Lokpal and Lokayukta are anti-corruption ombudsman institutions established to investigate complaints of corruption against public officials. The Lokpal functions at the Union level, while Lokayukta functions at the state level-Importance:- Prevention of corruption- Promoting transparency- Ensuring accountability- Strengthening integrity- Building public confidence- Their effectiveness depends on institutional independence, adequate resources and timely investigation of complaints.

18. Citizen's Charters enhance accountability in Kerala's Local Self-Government Institutions (LSGIs) in the following ways: Transparency- Time-bound services- Responsibility of officials- Grievance redressal- Citizen participation.

19. E-Governance refers to the use of Information and Communication Technology (ICT) by the government to provide public services, improve transparency, and promote efficient administration-challenges - Digital Divide- Lack of Digital Literacy- Cybersecurity and Privacy- Inadequate Infrastructure- Resistance to Change-Government employees and citizens may hesitate to adopt digital systems due to traditional practices, lack of training, or fear of technological change.

20. Akshaya E-Kendra is an e-governance initiative of the Government of Kerala aimed at providing digital services and promoting digital literacy among citizens.The role of Akshaya E-Kendra in reducing the digital divide are:- Digital Literacy- Access to Technology- E-Governance Services- Social Inclusion- Affordable and Accessible Services.**[5x6 = 30]**

Part CEssay QuestionsAnswer any 2 questionsEach question carries 15 marks

21. Administrative reforms aim to improve efficiency, transparency, accountability and responsiveness in public administration- Since independence, India has introduced several committees, commissions and institutional reforms to modernise administration- Major Committees and Commissions- A.D. Gorwala Report (1951- Paul H. Appleby Reports (1953 and 1956]- First Administrative Reforms Commission (1966–1970]- Kothari Committee (1974–1976]- Second Administrative Reforms Commission (2005–2009)- Major Administrative Reforms Introduced- Civil Service Reforms-Panchayati Raj Reforms (73rd Constitutional Amendment, 1992- Urban Local Government Reforms (74th Constitutional Amendment, 1992- Right to Information Act, 2005- E-Governance Initiatives - Citizen's Charters- Lokpal and Lokayuktas Act, 2013- Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT]- Mission Karmayogi (2020)- Administrative reforms in India have evolved from improving bureaucratic efficiency to promoting transparent, accountable, decentralised and citizen-centric governance- Effective implementation of reform recommendations remains essential for responsive and good governance.

22.The Right to Information (RTI) Act, 2005 is a landmark legislation in India enacted to promote transparency and accountability in public administration, curb corruption, and empower citizens. It came into full effect on October 12, 2005, replacing the earlier Freedom of Information Act, 2002- Objective- Right to Information- Public Authorities- Appointment of Information Officers- Time Limit- Application Procedure- Proactive Disclosure- Appeal Mechanism- Central Information Commission- State Information Commission- Penalties- Exemptions- Partial Disclosure- Overriding Effect- Importance.

23. The District Collector is one of the most important administrative officers in India-The office evolved from a colonial revenue-collection institution into a key position in district administration, development and public welfare- British East India Company Period (1772)- Cornwallis Reforms (1793)- Nineteenth Century- Indian Councils and Administrative Reforms- Government of India Act, 1919- Government of India Act, 1935- Post-Independence Period (1947 onwards)- Development Administration- Democratic Decentralisation-Contemporary Role-Its continuing relevance depends on administrative efficiency, democratic accountability, transparency and responsiveness to citizens.

24. The National e-Governance Plan (NeGP) was launched by the Government of India in 2006- Objectives-Improved Service Delivery- Transparency and Accountability- Citizen-Centric Governance- Reduction of Cost and Time- Common Service Centres (CSCs)- Integration of Government Departments- Digital Inclusion- Simplification of Procedures- Reliable Public Services- Effective Governance- Significance- Promotes good governance and administrative reforms- Improves accessibility of public services- Strengthens transparency and accountability- Encourages digital empowerment of citizens- Supports the development of a digital economy. The National e-Governance Plan marked an important step towards digital governance in India.**[15x2 = 30]**